

英検 3 級

過去問

長文問題集

収録内容

2007年度第3回～2017年度第3回

4[C] 次の英文の内容に関して、(31) から (35) までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なものを 1, 2, 3, 4 の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Kudzu* in America

Kudzu is the name of a plant. It is native* to Japan and China. Now it also grows in many places in the United States.

It was first brought to the U.S. in 1876. In that year, the American government* held a celebration for the United States' 100th birthday. Countries from around the world were asked to join the celebration. The Japanese government made a beautiful garden with kudzu and other plants from Japan. Many Americans visited the garden. They especially liked kudzu because they thought the flowers were pretty and smelled sweet. After that, many Americans planted it in their own gardens.

In the 1920s, Charles and Lillie Pleas found that animals liked to eat kudzu, and they began selling it to farmers. In the 1930s, many people also said kudzu was good for the soil,* so the American government asked farmers to plant it. The weather in the southern part of the U.S. was perfect for kudzu, and it grew much faster there than in China or Japan. But it grew too fast. Kudzu sometimes grew 30 centimeters in just one day and soon covered roads, bridges, and houses. Kudzu also killed forests because it grew over the trees.

In 1953, the American government stopped telling people to grow kudzu, but it already covered many areas. Some people think kudzu is useful and make baskets, paper, medicines, and food from it. But many towns and cities spend millions of dollars each year to kill kudzu and to keep it out of gardens and farms.

*kudzu: 葛

*native: 原産の

*government: 政府

*soil: 土

(31) When did kudzu first come to the United States?

- 1 In 1876.
- 2 In 1920.
- 3 In 1930.
- 4 In 1953.

(32) Who first brought kudzu to the United States?

- 1 A farmer who found it on a trip around the world.
- 2 An American who visited China.
- 3 The American government.
- 4 The Japanese government.

(33) What did many Americans think of kudzu at first?

- 1 They thought it smelled bad.
- 2 They thought it had pretty flowers.
- 3 They thought it was only good for farmers.
- 4 They thought it wouldn't grow well in the United States.

(34) Why did the American government stop telling people to plant kudzu?

- 1 Farm animals didn't like to eat it.
- 2 Farmers didn't know how to plant it.
- 3 It grew too fast and even killed forests.
- 4 It didn't grow well because of the weather.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 The flowers that Americans use to celebrate birthdays.
- 2 A plant that has become a big problem in the United States.
- 3 How American farmers take care of their plants and animals.
- 4 The best places to grow vegetables and other plants in the United States.

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Sylvia Earle

People have explored* many places around the world, but there are still places under the sea that people have not visited. Sylvia Earle is an explorer who loves the sea. She has worked hard to learn more about the plants and animals in it.

Earle was born in 1935. She grew up in New Jersey and Florida. When she was a little girl, she lived on a farm and loved playing outside. Her parents did not have much money, but Earle was able to go to university because she won scholarships.* At university, she learned to scuba-dive.* She thought she could learn a lot about plants and animals under the sea by scuba-diving.

After Earle became a scientist, she spent many hours under the water. This way, she was able to learn more than other scientists. During the 1960s, she got married and had two children, but she did not stop working.

In 1970, Earle took part in an interesting project. She lived in a special building under the sea with four other scientists for two weeks. After that, Earle became well known. She met the president of the United States and traveled to many countries. Later, she spent two years studying whales. In 1979, she went down almost 400 meters under the water and walked on the bottom* of the sea. That was deeper than any other person.

In the 1980s, Earle began to make machines to explore the bottom of the sea. Now, she works to protect the sea and the plants and animals in it.

*explore: 探検する

*scholarship: 奨学金

*scuba-dive: スキューバダイビングする

*bottom: 底

(31) What did Sylvia Earle enjoy doing when she was a child?

- 1 Playing outside.
- 2 Making machines.
- 3 Learning to scuba-dive.
- 4 Traveling to many countries.

(32) How was Earle able to learn more than other scientists?

- 1 By growing plants at home.
- 2 By using her parents' money.
- 3 By spending a lot of time under the water.
- 4 By studying at universities all over the world.

(33) How long did Earle stay under the sea during the special project in 1970?

- 1 For two weeks.
- 2 For four weeks.
- 3 For two years.
- 4 For four years.

(34) What happened in 1979?

- 1 Sylvia Earle got married.
- 2 Sylvia Earle moved to New Jersey.
- 3 Sylvia Earle won scholarships to go to university.
- 4 Sylvia Earle went deeper under the sea than anyone else.

(35) Who is this story about?

- 1 A woman who built a university in Florida.
- 2 A woman who is famous for studying the sea.
- 3 A woman who started a special farm in New Jersey.
- 4 A woman who got married to the president of the United States.

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October in Circleville

In the United States, pumpkins are very popular in fall. In October, many people use them as decorations* for Halloween. The city of Circleville in Ohio even has a special festival called the Circleville Pumpkin Show. Only about 13,000 people live there, but more than 400,000 people come to the festival every year.

The Pumpkin Show was started by George Haswell. In 1903, he was the mayor* of Circleville, and he asked farmers to display* their vegetables in front of his house. People liked the idea, and the next year, shops in Circleville helped him. Now it is one of the biggest festivals in America. It is held every October and lasts for four days. People don't need to buy tickets, so it is a great festival for families.

At the festival, there are cakes, ice cream, and many other foods made with pumpkin. More than 100,000 pumpkin doughnuts are sold. Every year, Lindsey's Bakery makes a special pumpkin pie. It is very big and weighs* about 180 kilograms. The pie is put in the shop's window, but it isn't sold. After the show, it is given to farmers to use as food for their pigs.

High school bands take part in parades on Main Street, and people can enjoy pie-eating contests and other fun events. There are also prizes for the heaviest fruits and vegetables. In 2007, Robert Liggett won first prize for the pumpkin he grew. It was 692 kilograms.

The people of Circleville are proud of their festival and look forward to this exciting event every year.

*decoration: 飾り

*mayor: 市長

*display: 展示する

*weigh: 重さがある

(31) How many people live in Circleville?

- 1 About 692.
- 2 About 13,000.
- 3 About 100,000.
- 4 About 400,000.

(32) Who started the Circleville Pumpkin Show?

- 1 Some shops on Main Street.
- 2 A farmer from another town.
- 3 The mayor of Circleville.
- 4 Teachers from the high school.

(33) The special pie made by Lindsey's Bakery is

- 1 sold to visitors to the festival.
- 2 used again the next year.
- 3 given to farmers for their animals.
- 4 eaten by high school students.

(34) What did Robert Liggett do in 2007?

- 1 He sold the most tickets.
- 2 He grew the heaviest pumpkin.
- 3 He made the biggest pumpkin pie.
- 4 He ate the most doughnuts.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 The festival that an American city holds every year.
- 2 How people started to grow pumpkins in America.
- 3 The history of Halloween and other American festivals.
- 4 The man who started the first bakery in America.

Matthew Flinders

Matthew Flinders was a sea captain. He traveled to Australia and made many important maps of the Australian continent.*

Flinders was born in England in 1774. When he was a boy, he read an adventure story called *Robinson Crusoe*. He loved the book and decided to become a sailor.* He joined the navy* when he was 15, and in 1795, he sailed to Australia. He spent five years there and drew many useful maps.

Flinders returned to England in 1800. In 1801, he got married. That year, the navy asked Flinders to make a second trip to Australia to draw more maps. He couldn't take his wife with him, so he was very sad. On this trip, Flinders became the first person to sail all the way around Australia. Some of the maps that he drew were used for more than a hundred years.

In 1803, Flinders left Australia for England. During the trip, he had to stop at a French island. England and France were fighting a war, so the French put him in jail.* After six and a half years, he was able to leave the island.

He arrived in England in 1810, but he was sick. He was only 36 years old, but he looked much older. In England, he wrote a famous book about his travels. At that time, people did not use the name Australia. In his book, Flinders called the continent Australia. Later, this name became popular and the navy began to use it, too. Flinders died in 1814 at the age of 40.

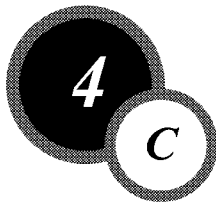
*Australian continent : オーストラリア大陸

*sailor : 水兵

*navy : 海軍

*jail : 牢屋

- (31) When did Flinders go to Australia for the first time?
- 1 In 1774.
 - 2 In 1795.
 - 3 In 1800.
 - 4 In 1801.
- (32) What made Flinders sad about his second trip to Australia?
- 1 He had to fight in a war.
 - 2 He could not reach Australia.
 - 3 The maps he drew were not good.
 - 4 His wife could not travel with him.
- (33) When Flinders was returning to England from his second trip, he
- 1 was put in jail.
 - 2 found many maps.
 - 3 joined the navy.
 - 4 took a vacation.
- (34) How long did Flinders have to spend on the French island?
- 1 Half a year.
 - 2 Six and a half years.
 - 3 Fifteen years.
 - 4 Thirty-six years.
- (35) After Flinders returned to England in 1810, he
- 1 read *Robinson Crusoe*.
 - 2 moved to France.
 - 3 wrote a book.
 - 4 became a sea captain.



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Sleeping Bear Dunes*

Lake Michigan is a very big lake in the United States. Near one part of the lake, there are many dunes. From the top of the dunes, people can see two islands in the lake. This area is a national park* called Sleeping Bear Dunes. The name of the park comes from an old story. Native Americans* told the story many years ago. They thought that one special dune looked like a sleeping bear.

They said that there was a fire in the forest a long time ago. A mother bear and her two children swam into the lake to get away from the fire. The little bears were good at swimming, but the other side of the lake was far away. They swam for many days. Finally, the little bears became very tired. They could not swim anymore, and they drowned.*

When the mother bear reached the other side, she could not see her children. She was very worried. She wanted to look for her children, so she climbed to the top of a dune. She was so tired that she fell asleep. A god saw her and felt sad for her. The god changed the little bears into the two islands in the lake. The god also changed the mother bear into a big dune. After that, people said that the mother bear would always be able to see her children in the lake.

These days, many people visit Sleeping Bear Dunes to enjoy the beautiful nature there.

*dune: 砂丘さきゅう

*national park: 国立公園こくりつこうえん

*Native American: アメリカの先住民せんじゅうみん

*drown: 溺れるおぼ

(31)

What is Sleeping Bear Dunes?

- 1 A lake in the United States.
- 2 A big island near the United States.
- 3 A national park near Lake Michigan.
- 4 A large zoo with many bears.

(32)

Why did the bears go into the lake?

- 1 They were looking for a place to sleep.
- 2 They wanted to get away from a fire.
- 3 They wanted to learn to swim.
- 4 They were looking for other bears.

(33)

Why did the mother bear become worried?

- 1 She made a god angry.
- 2 She was not a good swimmer.
- 3 She was lost in the forest.
- 4 She could not find her children.

(34)

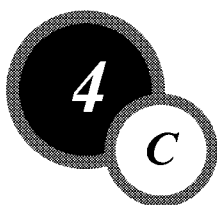
What did the mother bear do after she crossed the lake?

- 1 She played with her children.
- 2 She swam across the lake again.
- 3 She went to the top of a dune.
- 4 She asked a god for help.

(35)

What is this story about?

- 1 How a special place got its name.
- 2 How bears learn to swim in lakes.
- 3 How people stop fires in the United States.
- 4 How visitors can travel to Lake Michigan.



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Jim Thorpe

Jim Thorpe was one of the best American athletes* of the 20th century. He was in the 1912 Olympics. He also played professional football, professional baseball, and even professional basketball.

Thorpe was born near the town of Prague, Oklahoma, on May 28, 1887. Two of Thorpe's grandparents were Native American,* and he went to a school for Native American children in Oklahoma. In 1904, he began to study at the Carlisle Indian Industrial School in Carlisle, Pennsylvania. He played football and other sports at the school. Thorpe first became well known when the school football team played against Harvard University in 1911. Harvard had a very strong team, but Thorpe's team won. Thorpe got all of his team's points.

In 1912, Thorpe was invited to the Summer Olympics in Sweden with the American team. He took part in four events. He won gold medals in two of them, the pentathlon* and the decathlon.* When Thorpe returned to America, people in New York held a large parade for him.

The next year, Thorpe joined the New York Giants baseball team, and in 1915, he also joined a professional football team, the Canton Bulldogs. Thorpe was chosen as the first president of the American Professional Football Association in 1920.

In 1951, a movie was made about the life of Jim Thorpe. Today, many people still remember the name of this great athlete who was good at so many sports.

*athlete: スポーツ選手

*Native American: アメリカ先住民

*pentathlon: 5種競技

*decathlon: 10種競技

(31)

What happened in 1904?

- 1** Thorpe was born in Oklahoma.
- 2** Thorpe started studying in Pennsylvania.
- 3** Thorpe went on a school trip to New York.
- 4** Thorpe moved to Sweden.

(32)

How did Thorpe first become well known?

- 1** He won an important race.
- 2** He invented a new sport for Native Americans.
- 3** He played in a football game against Harvard University.
- 4** He became the captain of the American basketball team.

(33)

How many gold medals did Thorpe win in 1912?

- 1** One.
- 2** Two.
- 3** Four.
- 4** Five.

(34)

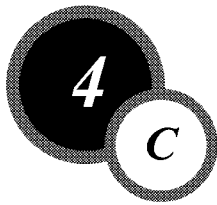
What did Thorpe do in 1913?

- 1** He held a big parade for other athletes.
- 2** He joined a professional baseball team.
- 3** He decided to stop playing sports.
- 4** He made a movie about his life.

(35)

What was special about Jim Thorpe?

- 1** He started the first football team in America.
- 2** He went to the Olympic Games in many countries.
- 3** He could play many different sports very well.
- 4** He taught sports at many colleges around America.



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The Elephant Sanctuary*

Elephants are popular at zoos and circuses* in the United States, but they are very big and eat a lot. Taking care of them is very expensive. Zoos and circuses often cannot take care of elephants when they get old. One reason is because they don't have enough money. Carol Buckley wanted to make a place for older elephants from zoos and circuses to live. In 1995, she built the Elephant Sanctuary in a big park in Tennessee. At the sanctuary, these elephants live like wild elephants in nature, not like pets.

In the beginning, the sanctuary had just one elephant, but more came every year. The sanctuary now has 15 elephants. All of the elephants are female,* because in nature, male* elephants usually live alone. The oldest is 61 years old, and the youngest is 27. The elephants at the Elephant Sanctuary enjoy being part of a large group, and they have a lot of space. There are warm buildings for the elephants in cold weather, and doctors take care of them if they get sick. The park has fields, forests, and a large lake for them to enjoy. Visitors and tourists cannot come and see the elephants. The only people the elephants meet are the people who take care of them.

After working for the circus or staying in a zoo for many years, elephants can have a good life at the sanctuary. Carol Buckley wants to help many elephants. In the future, she hopes to make the sanctuary big enough for 100 elephants to live there.

*sanctuary: 保護区域 (ほごくいき)

*circus: サーカス

*female: メス

*male: オス

(31) Why is it sometimes hard for zoos and circuses to keep elephants?

- 1** They do not live very long.
- 2** They are expensive to take care of.
- 3** They are not popular with visitors.
- 4** They get sick easily.

(32) Carol Buckley built the sanctuary to

- 1** sell elephants to zoos and circuses.
- 2** show elephants to visitors.
- 3** give older elephants a place to live.
- 4** have some elephants as pets.

(33) How many elephants were kept at the sanctuary when it started?

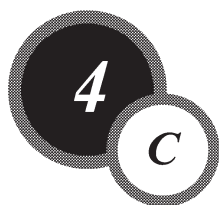
- 1** 1.
- 2** 15.
- 3** 27.
- 4** 100.

(34) Why does the sanctuary only have female elephants?

- 1** Females can live better in cold weather.
- 2** Females need more space than males.
- 3** Male elephants aren't used in circuses and zoos.
- 4** Male elephants don't usually live with other elephants in nature.

(35) What does Carol Buckley want to do in the future?

- 1** Send the sanctuary elephants back to their countries.
- 2** Bring more elephants to the sanctuary.
- 3** Teach people to ride sanctuary elephants.
- 4** Invite many tourists to the sanctuary.



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A Special Doctor

In the 1800s, some women wanted to study to become doctors, but they couldn't. People didn't think that women could be doctors. The first woman in the United States to graduate from medical school* was Elizabeth Blackwell.

She was born in England in 1821. She didn't go to school when she was a child, but her father asked a teacher to come to their house. The teacher showed her how to read and write at home. The family moved to the U.S. in 1832, and Blackwell decided to become a doctor. She studied medicine* by herself and worked as a music teacher to save money.

Blackwell tried to enter many medical schools, but she couldn't because she was a woman. Finally, she was able to go to Geneva College. She was the only woman student, and some people weren't kind to her. But she studied very hard. When she graduated in 1849, she was the best student in her class. After that, she traveled to England and France to study more.

Blackwell went back to America to work as a doctor, but the hospitals there didn't want a woman doctor. She bought a house in New York City in 1854 and began helping sick women and children there. Later, she built a clinic* for poor people in New York City.

Other women wanted to study medicine, and Blackwell helped them. She started a medical school for women in America and another school in England. Because of Elizabeth Blackwell, many women decided to study medicine and they became doctors.

*medical school: 医学部, 医科大学

*medicine: 医学

*clinic: 診療所

(31) Why was it difficult for women to go to medical school in the 1800s?

- 1** There weren't enough schools for doctors.
- 2** People thought women couldn't be doctors.
- 3** Women were able to make medicine at home.
- 4** There were too many doctors in the U.S.

(32) Blackwell learned to read and write

- 1** at a clinic.
- 2** at her home.
- 3** at medical school.
- 4** at a girls' school.

(33) When did Blackwell finish studying at Geneva College?

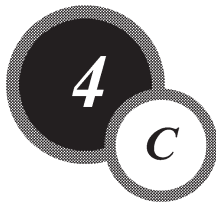
- 1** In 1821.
- 2** In 1832.
- 3** In 1849.
- 4** In 1854.

(34) What did Blackwell do in New York City?

- 1** She worked as a music teacher.
- 2** She took care of her sick father.
- 3** She started a school to teach boys and girls together.
- 4** She built a clinic for people who didn't have money.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1** The first woman doctor in the U.S.
- 2** The most famous hospital in New York City.
- 3** The first school for doctors in England.
- 4** The most popular doctor in France.



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A Special Kind of Zoo

One of the most famous zoos in the world is the San Diego Zoo in California. It has more than 4,000 animals. Zoos are now better places for animals to live thanks to the San Diego Zoo.

At the start of the 20th century, all zoo animals were kept in small cages.* The animals were not healthy and became sick easily. Most died when they were very young. When Doctor Harry Wegeforth started a new zoo in San Diego, he wanted the animals in his zoo to have more space. He built moats* around open spaces. The animals could not run away because they could not cross the moats. In 1922, he made the first lion area without any fences in a zoo. At first, visitors were afraid the lions would attack them. But they soon learned that this new kind of zoo was both safe and exciting. Today, the San Diego Zoo has thousands of acres,* and the animals have a lot of space.

Scientists at the zoo also try to learn more about animals to help the environment. They study many special animals such as pandas and tigers. They even return some of them to nature. Workers at the zoo grow many kinds of plants for the animals. For example, they grow 40 kinds of bamboo for the zoo's pandas to eat. Today, the zoo has the largest number of pandas outside of China.

Because of the San Diego Zoo, we understand more about animals and how to protect them.

*cage: おり

*moat: 堀

*acre: エーカー (面積単位)

(31)

At the start of the 20th century,

- 1 people weren't interested in zoos.
- 2 there were no zoos in California.
- 3 zoos didn't have lions or tigers.
- 4 zoo animals got sick easily.

(32)

What did Doctor Harry Wegeforth want to do?

- 1 Keep more kinds of animals than other zoos.
- 2 Return some of his zoo animals to nature.
- 3 Give his zoo animals a lot of space.
- 4 Travel to many zoos around the world.

(33)

What happened at the San Diego Zoo in 1922?

- 1 The tigers ran away.
- 2 A lion area without fences was built.
- 3 A lion attacked a visitor.
- 4 The first tiger in the U.S. was born.

(34)

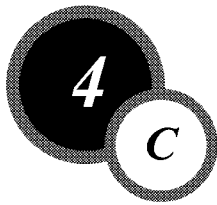
Why do workers grow plants at the San Diego Zoo?

- 1 To give them to the animals to eat.
- 2 To give them to zoo visitors.
- 3 To sell them to stores in San Diego.
- 4 To use them to build fences.

(35)

What is this story about?

- 1 The first zoo to keep animals in cages.
- 2 The first panda kept in a zoo in China.
- 3 A city that decided to close its zoos.
- 4 A zoo that is kind to its animals.



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Chester Greenwood

On cold winter days, some people wear earmuffs* to keep their ears warm. But not many people know that the person who invented* earmuffs was a 15-year-old boy from the United States.

Chester Greenwood was born in Farmington, Maine in 1858. Farmington is very snowy, and Chester's big ears were always cold in winter. One winter day in 1873, Chester went outside to try a new pair of ice skates. The cold wind hurt his ears. Suddenly, Chester had an idea, so he ran back home. He got a piece of soft wire,* and he made a circle at each end of the wire. Then he asked his grandmother to cover the circles with pieces of cloth. He put them on his head and went back outside. The pieces of cloth kept his ears warm. People started to call them " earmuffs."

When other kids saw Chester's earmuffs, they wanted them, too. Soon earmuffs became popular everywhere. When Chester was 18, he built a factory in Farmington. In 1883, his factory was making 30,000 earmuffs each year. By 1937, it was making 400,000 of them every year. Chester died that year.

These days, Farmington is known as the "Earmuff Center of the World," and Chester is a hero there. The first Saturday in December is always "Chester Greenwood Day" in Farmington. Everyone from children to dogs wears earmuffs. There is a long parade of police cars and school buses, and people can see many kinds of earmuffs on that day.

* earmuffs: ^{みみ} 耳あて

* invent: ^{はつめい} ～を発明する

* wire: ^{はりかね} 針金

(31) Why did Chester run back home on a winter day?

- 1 His ice skates were broken.
- 2 He wanted to see his sick grandmother.
- 3 His friends laughed at him.
- 4 He thought of a good idea.

(32) When did Chester first make earmuffs?

- 1 In 1858.
- 2 In 1873.
- 3 In 1883.
- 4 In 1937.

(33) How did Chester's grandmother help him?

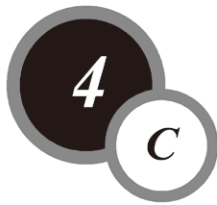
- 1 She found the wire for his earmuffs.
- 2 She put pieces of cloth on his earmuffs.
- 3 She gave him the idea for the earmuffs.
- 4 She bought his first pair of earmuffs.

(34) How many earmuffs was the factory making in 1937?

- 1 30,000.
- 2 40,000.
- 3 300,000.
- 4 400,000.

(35) What happens in Farmington on the first Saturday in December?

- 1 The people have the Farmington Snow Festival.
- 2 The people celebrate the beginning of winter.
- 3 The people have a parade to remember Chester.
- 4 The people celebrate the city's birthday.



つぎ えいぶん ないよう かん
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Roald Dahl

Roald Dahl is famous because of the stories he wrote for children. His most popular book is *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory*, but he wrote books for adults, too. He also had a very interesting life.

Dahl was born in Wales in 1916. As a boy, he went to some different boarding schools* in England. He had fun, but some of the teachers were not very kind. Many of Dahl's stories came from his school experiences. One of his schools was next to a chocolate factory. The factory often asked the students to try new kinds of candy. Dahl remembered this when he wrote *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory*.

In 1936, Dahl went to Africa to work. He had many adventures with wild animals there. He wrote about these experiences later. In 1939, after World War II began, Dahl joined the Royal Air Force* as a pilot. But on his first trip, his plane crashed,* and he was hurt badly. After about a year, he could fly again. He was a good pilot, and he won many battles.* He left the air force in 1942 and moved to America.

In the U.S., he met Patricia Neal, a famous actress. He married her in 1953, and they had five children. Dahl told stories to his children. Later, he wrote the stories down as books. He wrote *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory* in 1964. After that, he wrote many other books that are loved by people around the world. He died in 1990 after a long and exciting life.

*boarding school: ぜんりょうせい がっこう 全寮制の学校

*Royal Air Force: えいこくくうぐん 英国空軍

*crash: ついらく 墜落する

*battle: せんとう 戦闘

(31) Where did Roald Dahl get the ideas for his stories?

- 1** From his good friends in Africa.
 - 2** From the workers at the chocolate factory.
 - 3** From his experiences at school and work.
 - 4** From the books he read about animals.
-

(32) When did Dahl become a pilot for the Royal Air Force?

- 1** In 1936.
 - 2** In 1939.
 - 3** In 1942.
 - 4** In 1953.
-

(33) What happened to Dahl in the war?

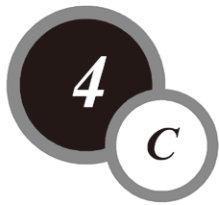
- 1** He had an accident in his plane.
 - 2** He wrote his most popular stories.
 - 3** He flew to America by himself.
 - 4** He married a famous actress.
-

(34) What did Dahl write in his books?

- 1** Stories he heard during the war.
 - 2** Stories he remembered about his wife.
 - 3** Stories he told to his children.
 - 4** Stories he collected from around the world.
-

(35) Dahl was a writer who

- 1** often worked with wild animals.
- 2** wrote interesting books for everyone.
- 3** wrote books about movie stars.
- 4** became a school teacher.



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An Animal Hero

Gorillas* are very large and strong animals. They look dangerous, but they can be very kind. They help other gorillas when they are hurt* or sad. Sometimes they even help humans.

One gorilla that helped a human was Binti Jua. Binti was born in Ohio in 1988. In 1991, she was moved to live with other gorillas at the Brookfield Zoo, near Chicago. In 1995, when Binti was seven, she had her first baby, Koola.

On August 16, 1996, a three-year-old boy was visiting the zoo with his parents. The boy was looking at the gorillas. There was a wall around the gorillas' area, but the boy climbed the wall. Then he fell six meters onto the hard ground. The boy was hurt and could not get up. Binti went over to the boy. The people watching them were worried. They thought that Binti would hurt the boy.

Binti growled* when another gorilla came near the boy. The other gorillas tried to touch him, but Binti stopped them. She picked the boy up and carried him to a door 18 meters away. The zoo workers could reach the boy easily from there. The boy was taken to the hospital, and he got better a few days later.

Binti became famous for saving the boy. Newspapers around the world wrote stories about her. Everyone called her a hero. She still lives at the Brookfield Zoo with Koola and her second baby, Bakari. Many people come to the zoo just to see Binti Jua, the famous gorilla hero.

*gorilla: ゴリラ

*hurt: 傷きずついた

*growl: うなる

(31) When was Binti Jua's first baby born?

- 1** In 1988.
 - 2** In 1991.
 - 3** In 1995.
 - 4** In 1996.
-

(32) The boy was hurt when

- 1** he was hit by a gorilla.
 - 2** he fell from a high wall.
 - 3** he was caught in a door.
 - 4** he gave food to a gorilla.
-

(33) Why were the people worried?

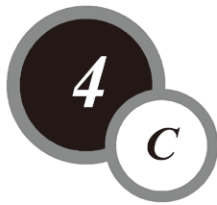
- 1** They thought Binti Jua would hurt the boy.
 - 2** They thought the other gorillas would take the boy.
 - 3** They thought the boy would scare the baby gorilla.
 - 4** They thought Binti Jua would fight with the other gorillas.
-

(34) What did Binti Jua do?

- 1** She got angry at the zoo workers.
 - 2** She brought the boy to the other gorillas.
 - 3** She gave the boy some water.
 - 4** She took the boy to a safe place.
-

(35) What is this story about?

- 1** How wild gorillas protect their babies.
- 2** The first gorilla at the Brookfield Zoo.
- 3** How zoo workers train baby gorillas.
- 4** A gorilla that saved a child.



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Truffles*

Truffles are one of the most expensive kinds of food in the world. They grow under the ground near the roots* of some kinds of trees. They taste delicious, but they are quite difficult to find. White truffles grow in northern Italy and are the most expensive kind. They usually cost between \$2,000 and \$4,850 for one kilogram. In December 2007, a man bought a 1.5-kilogram white truffle from Italy for \$330,000. It was the biggest and most expensive truffle in the world. Black truffles are also popular, but they are smaller than white truffles. They are cheaper than white truffles because they are easier to find. European black truffles cost between \$300 and \$1,200 for one kilogram.

People cannot find truffles because they are under the ground, but some animals can smell them. Pigs can smell truffles very well, so they are easy to teach. But pigs love to eat truffles, so it is a problem. Now, more and more people are teaching dogs to find truffles. Dogs are not as good at finding truffles as pigs, but they do not eat the truffles.

Because truffles can be sold for a lot of money, people are trying to grow them all over the world. In 1992, a farmer in North Carolina became the first person to grow European black truffles in the United States. People are also trying to grow European black truffles in Oregon, California, and Washington. If truffles can be grown in many different places, they will become cheaper in the future.

*truffle: トリュフ (食用キノコの種類)

*root: 根

(31) What happened in December 2007?

- 1 The first black truffle was grown in Europe.
- 2 The most expensive truffle in the world was sold.
- 3 People began eating black truffles in the U.S.
- 4 People started using dogs to find truffles.

(32) Why are black truffles cheaper than white truffles?

- 1 It is easier to find black truffles.
- 2 Black truffles aren't popular in Italy.
- 3 Black truffles aren't as sweet as white ones.
- 4 Pigs can't smell white truffles.

(33) Why are people using dogs to look for truffles?

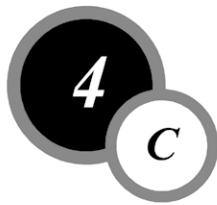
- 1 Dogs are better at seeing truffles.
- 2 Dogs do not eat truffles.
- 3 Dogs are easier to teach than pigs.
- 4 Dogs can walk faster than pigs.

(34) Where in the U.S. did a farmer first grow European black truffles?

- 1 In North Carolina.
- 2 In Oregon.
- 3 In California.
- 4 In Washington.

(35) What is the story about?

- 1 A new way to grow food in Europe.
- 2 People who love expensive food.
- 3 A famous kind of pig from northern Italy.
- 4 A special food that grows under the ground.



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Abbie Burgess

About 200 years ago, there were no airplanes or trains in the United States, so people used ships to travel. Some areas were very dangerous for ships, so lighthouses* were built in these places. At night, people on ships knew they had to be careful when they saw the light on the top of a lighthouse. The people who took care of lighthouses were called lighthouse keepers, and their job was very important.

In 1853, a 14-year-old girl named Abbie Burgess moved to an island in Maine with her family. No other people lived on the island, and Abbie's father was the lighthouse keeper. Abbie helped her father in the lighthouse. She learned how to clean the lights in the lighthouse and do many other things. The lights had to shine* brightly until morning.

Just before winter in 1856, Abbie's father had to leave the island to buy food. He had to go 25 miles by boat to get to the nearest town. He told Abbie to take care of their family and the lighthouse. After he left, a big storm came, and it was the biggest storm in 100 years. It rained and snowed for four weeks, so Abbie's father could not return to the island. Abbie took care of the lighthouse by herself for one month.

Finally, Abbie's father came back. He was very happy because his family was safe. Abbie did a great job. Her work saved many people's lives. Abbie became the assistant* lighthouse keeper in 1862.

*lighthouse: 灯台 (とうだい)

*shine: 光る (ひかる)

*assistant: 補佐 (ほさ) の

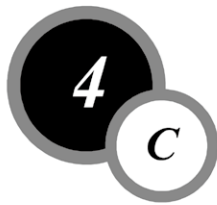
- (31) What did lighthouses do?
- 1 They helped ships to find other ships.
 - 2 They told ships about dangerous areas.
 - 3 They told people that storms were coming.
 - 4 They helped people on land at night.

- (32) When did Abbie Burgess move to the island?
- 1 In 1852.
 - 2 In 1853.
 - 3 In 1856.
 - 4 In 1862.

- (33) Why did Abbie's father have to leave the island?
- 1 To get food.
 - 2 To find a job.
 - 3 To see his family.
 - 4 To help people on a ship.

- (34) How long was the big storm?
- 1 One week.
 - 2 About two weeks.
 - 3 About a month.
 - 4 100 days.

- (35) What is this story about?
- 1 The oldest lighthouse in the United States.
 - 2 A young girl who took care of a lighthouse.
 - 3 People traveling by ship in the 1800s.
 - 4 A famous island in Maine.



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A Popular Food

Many people think that pizza comes from Italy. But actually, it was first made in Greece. Around the 1st or 2nd century, the Greeks baked large, flat pieces of bread, and put herbs,* onions, and other vegetables on top. In the early 1500s, travelers brought tomatoes to Europe from South America. Many people thought that tomatoes were dangerous to eat, but poor people in Naples, Italy, tried them because they were hungry. They baked tomatoes and herbs on flat pieces of bread. By the 1600s, people were visiting the poor areas of Naples to try this new dish.

The kind of pizza that is popular today was made in 1889. The queen of Italy, Margherita, was visiting Bologna. A famous chef named Raffaele Esposito was asked to make dinner for her. He decided to make a special pizza with tomatoes, cheese, and fresh basil* on top. Red, white, and green were the colors of the Italian flag. Esposito called the new dish Pizza Margherita. It became one of the queen's favorite foods, and Italians everywhere began to enjoy it. People in different parts of Italy also made other kinds of pizza. Some had meat or fish, cheese, and other vegetables on them.

In the 1940s, many U.S. soldiers* were in Italy during World War II.* These soldiers tasted pizza for the first time, and they loved it. When they went back home after the war, they wanted to eat it again. Soon, there were pizza restaurants in most U.S. cities, and pizza became a popular food all around the country.

*herb: ハーブ

*basil: バジル

*soldier: 兵士

*World War II: 第二次世界大戦

(31) Where was pizza first made?

- 1** In Greece.
 - 2** In Italy.
 - 3** In the United States.
 - 4** In South America.
-

(32) What did poor people in Naples do?

- 1** They put cheese on their pizza.
 - 2** They baked bread with tomatoes and herbs on top.
 - 3** They made a new kind of pizza for the queen.
 - 4** They made money by selling vegetables.
-

(33) What was special about Raffaele Esposito's pizza?

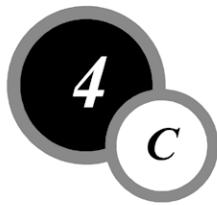
- 1** It had meat on it.
 - 2** It was made by the queen.
 - 3** It used the colors of the Italian flag.
 - 4** It was popular with poor people.
-

(34) Why did pizza become popular in the United States?

- 1** U.S. soldiers wanted to eat it.
 - 2** Cooks wanted to make it.
 - 3** Italian soldiers brought it there.
 - 4** Italian restaurants sold it cheaply.
-

(35) What is this story about?

- 1** Pizza and its history.
- 2** Cities and their famous restaurants.
- 3** Why vegetables are popular in the United States.
- 4** Foods that came to Europe from South America.



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A Festival in Sibenik

There are many children's festivals in cities around Europe. These festivals have music, dancing, and performances* just for children. At some children's festivals, children can learn more about the performers and their work in special workshops.*

One of the oldest children's festivals is the Sibenik Children's Festival in Sibenik, Croatia, in southeastern Europe. This festival was first held in 1958. Some people started the festival to teach children about all kinds of art. The festival soon became famous all over the world. Every June, the best performers from Croatia and around the world come to Sibenik to perform, teach classes, and talk about their work. In 2012, there were more than 1,200 performers in about 135 plays and shows. The festival is 15 days long, and there are many different performances every day. Many of them are in the evening. On some days, they do not end until midnight.

At most international children's festivals, the performers are adults, and the children just watch the shows. But in Sibenik, almost half of the performances are by children and young adults. This makes the festival quite different. The performances are not only in theaters. Musicians, dancers, and acrobats* also perform in the streets around the town.

In the 1990s, there was a war in Croatia. Although it was a difficult time, the Sibenik Children's Festival was held. It brought happiness to people of all ages. Now, the country is peaceful, and the festival is more popular than before.

*performance: 芸 (げい)

*workshop: 体験学習 (たいけん がくしゅう)

*acrobat: 曲芸師 (きょくげい し)

(31) At some children's festivals, children can

- 1** take special workshops.
 - 2** become famous artists.
 - 3** be on television.
 - 4** learn to make toys.
-

(32) What happened in 1958?

- 1** The first Sibenik Children's Festival was held.
 - 2** Dancers from Sibenik performed around the world.
 - 3** Children from Sibenik traveled around Croatia.
 - 4** Children from Sibenik wrote a book about their city.
-

(33) How many plays and shows were there in the Sibenik Children's Festival in 2012?

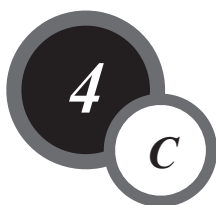
- 1** About 15.
 - 2** About 135.
 - 3** About 1,200.
 - 4** About 1,990.
-

(34) What makes the Sibenik Children's Festival different from other children's festivals?

- 1** There are many performances by children.
 - 2** Many of the artists were born in Sibenik.
 - 3** There are many concerts by professional musicians.
 - 4** Many of the best dancers in the world move to Sibenik.
-

(35) What is this story about?

- 1** A special event made for children.
- 2** The world's newest children's festival.
- 3** Children who want to become acrobats.
- 4** Famous performers from Croatia.



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For a Rainy Day

On a rainy day, you will see many people with umbrellas. Sometimes, people use them when it is sunny, too. But where did umbrellas come from?

Umbrellas were used thousands of years ago in countries such as Egypt and China. At first, people only used umbrellas to stay cool on hot days. Later, umbrellas for the rain were made by the Chinese.

In Europe, people started using umbrellas in the 17th century. Only women used umbrellas then. They thought umbrellas looked pretty. So, when a man called Jonas Hanway carried an umbrella around London, people laughed at him. He kept using his umbrella for 30 years, and other men began using umbrellas, too. They often called their umbrellas “Hanways” because of Jonas Hanway.

In 1830, the first shop that only sold umbrellas opened in London. It is still there today, at 53 New Oxford Street. At that time, umbrellas were usually made of wood and were very heavy. Then, in 1852, a man called Samuel Fox invented* umbrellas made of steel.* But only rich people could buy them.

In the 1920s in Germany, someone invented a very small umbrella that could be put in your pocket. This one was like the umbrellas some people use today. In the 1960s, nylon* umbrellas became popular because they were light and cheap. Then, the number of people who use umbrellas grew around the world. Today, about 33 million umbrellas are sold every year in the United States, and most of them are made in China.

*invent: ～を^{はつめい}発明する

*steel: スチール

*nylon: ナイロン

(31) Where did people first make umbrellas for rainy days?

- 1 In China.
 - 2 In Egypt.
 - 3 In Germany.
 - 4 In England.
-

(32) Men in London called their umbrellas “Hanways” because

- 1 Jonas Hanway invented the umbrella.
 - 2 there was an umbrella shop called Hanways.
 - 3 Jonas Hanway was the first man there to use an umbrella.
 - 4 umbrellas were made in a town called Hanway.
-

(33) What is at 53 New Oxford Street?

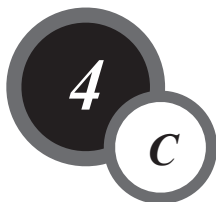
- 1 Jonas Hanway’s house.
 - 2 Samuel Fox’s factory.
 - 3 An umbrella museum.
 - 4 The first umbrella shop.
-

(34) When was the pocket umbrella invented?

- 1 In 1830.
 - 2 In 1852.
 - 3 In the 1920s.
 - 4 In the 1960s.
-

(35) When did umbrellas become popular around the world?

- 1 When it started raining a lot.
- 2 When people started using nylon ones.
- 3 When Samuel Fox made steel ones.
- 4 When the Americans began making them.



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A Delicious Cookie

A chocolate chip cookie is a cookie with pieces of chocolate. It is a favorite snack for people of all ages, and there is an interesting story about this cookie.

Ruth Graves Wakefield was born in 1903 in the United States. After graduating from university, she worked as a cooking teacher. Then, she and her husband bought an old building. Before, it was a hotel for travelers on long trips. They changed it into a restaurant called the Toll House Inn.

Ruth was a really good cook. People came from far away to try the delicious food at her restaurant. One day in 1930, she was making chocolate cookies. At that time, people cooked with a special type of chocolate called baking chocolate. Ruth found out that she didn't have any more baking chocolate. She didn't know what to do. Then, she had an idea. She cut a chocolate bar into small pieces and put them into the cookies. She thought the chocolate would melt* in the oven.*

When Ruth tried the cookies, she was surprised. The chocolate pieces were still there. She gave the cookies to people in town, and they loved them. In 1936, she wrote a book with her recipe* in it. That made the cookies famous.

A food company called Nestlé sold a lot of chocolate chips because many people made these cookies. Nestlé put Ruth's recipe on its bags of chocolate chips in 1939. Because of this, Ruth received free chocolate chips for her whole life. Now, people around the world like eating chocolate chip cookies.

*melt: とろける

*oven: オーブン

*recipe: レシピ

(31) What was the Wakefields' restaurant before?

- 1 A hotel.
 - 2 A cooking school.
 - 3 A bakery.
 - 4 A university.
-

(32) Why did people from far away come to the Toll House Inn?

- 1 To take cooking lessons.
 - 2 Ruth's husband was a famous cook.
 - 3 To enjoy Ruth's good food.
 - 4 It was popular since it opened in 1903.
-

(33) After making the cookies, Ruth was surprised because

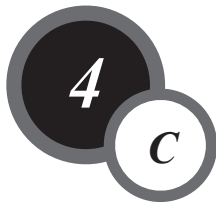
- 1 people in town didn't like them.
 - 2 pieces of chocolate were still in them.
 - 3 she forgot the recipe for the cookies.
 - 4 cookies with no chocolate were more popular.
-

(34) When did Ruth write her book?

- 1 In 1903.
 - 2 In 1930.
 - 3 In 1936.
 - 4 In 1939.
-

(35) Why did Nestlé give Ruth free chocolate chips?

- 1 It changed the name of her cookies.
- 2 It put her recipe on its chocolate chip bags.
- 3 It asked her to make a lot of cookies.
- 4 It wanted to write a book about her life.



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Rick Hansen

Rick Hansen is one of Canada's most famous athletes.* He has won many prizes in wheelchair* races and other wheelchair sports. He has also done many things to help other people with disabilities.*

Rick was born in British Columbia in 1957. He was very good at sports when he was young, and his dream was to be in the Olympics. But when he was 15, Rick was in a car accident. Because of the accident, he could not walk, and he had to use a wheelchair. After high school, Rick went to university and first played wheelchair basketball, wheelchair volleyball, and other wheelchair sports there. He was very good at these sports, and he won many prizes. After graduating from university, he won six medals in wheelchair racing at the Paralympic Games in 1980 and 1984.

In 1985, Rick began a trip around the world called the "Man in Motion World Tour." He pushed himself in his wheelchair 40,000 kilometers across 34 countries. He traveled about 84 kilometers a day. The tour took two years and was very hard. Rick did this tour to collect money for people with disabilities. He also wanted others to understand people with disabilities better. The tour was a big success. It collected \$26 million to help people with disabilities, and people around the world learned more about people in wheelchairs.

In 1997, Rick started the Rick Hansen Foundation. This group helps people with disabilities in many ways. Rick's hard work has changed many people's lives and will help people in the future.

*athlete: スポーツ選手

*wheelchair: 車椅子

*disability: 障がい

(31) What happened when Rick Hansen was 15?

- 1** He was in an accident.
 - 2** He finished high school.
 - 3** He won a marathon.
 - 4** He made a wheelchair.
-

(32) What did Rick do for the first time in university?

- 1** He went to the Paralympic Games.
 - 2** He played wheelchair sports.
 - 3** He learned to drive a car.
 - 4** He traveled to other countries.
-

(33) How long was the “Man in Motion World Tour”?

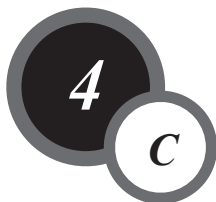
- 1** 2 months.
 - 2** 84 days.
 - 3** 2 years.
 - 4** 34 months.
-

(34) Thanks to the tour, people

- 1** learned more about people with disabilities.
 - 2** started a sports contest for people in wheelchairs.
 - 3** built schools for children around the world.
 - 4** started a company for making wheelchairs.
-

(35) What is this story about?

- 1** A man in a wheelchair who has helped many people.
- 2** Canada’s first wheelchair basketball player.
- 3** The people who started the Paralympic Games.
- 4** University students who help athletes with disabilities.



つぎ えいぶん ないよう かん
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もっと てきせつ ふん かんせい もっと てきせつ
最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを 1, 2,
3, 4 の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

The Kiwi Bird

Kiwis are special birds that are from New Zealand. There are five kinds of kiwis. They are about the size of a chicken, but they look really different from other birds. Kiwis cannot fly. They have very small wings, so it is hard to see them. They have no tails,* and long beaks* for getting food. Kiwis like to eat bugs that live in the ground. They can smell very well, so they can find food easily. Kiwi eggs are big and heavy. Kiwis look funny, but they can run really fast.

Kiwis are a symbol of New Zealand, but most people have never seen one in nature because they sleep during the day. They only move around at night. Kiwis also have strong legs, so they can run away quickly if they hear any noise.

Before people came to live in New Zealand, there were about 12 million kiwis. But when people arrived, they brought different animals with them, such as cats and dogs. These animals liked to eat kiwis and kiwi eggs. Today, there are only about 50,000 kiwis, and the number is getting smaller. People in New Zealand are trying to save the kiwis. Some are protected in special zoos or parks.

Around the world, it is hard to find a kiwi in a zoo. Only 13 zoos outside of New Zealand have a kiwi. Six of these zoos are in the United States. Kiwis are not big birds, but they are probably one of the most famous.

*tail: 尾^お

*beak: くちばし

(31)

What do kiwis look like?

- 1 They have long tails.
- 2 They have no wings.
- 3 They have sharp teeth.
- 4 They have long beaks.

(32)

Most people have never seen kiwis in nature because kiwis

- 1 only move around at night.
- 2 fly away when they hear a noise.
- 3 only live in tall trees.
- 4 are too small to see.

(33)

Why is there a smaller number of kiwis now?

- 1 People liked to eat their eggs.
- 2 Many zoos around the world studied them.
- 3 Animals like cats and dogs ate many of them.
- 4 They don't run away from any noise.

(34)

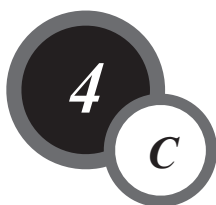
How many kiwis are there today?

- 1 About 6,000.
- 2 About 13,000.
- 3 About 50,000.
- 4 About 12 million.

(35)

What is this story about?

- 1 A special and famous bird from New Zealand.
- 2 How the kiwi bird got its name.
- 3 Why kiwis cannot live in zoos.
- 4 Why kiwis are popular pets in New Zealand.



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George Eliot

Some of the most famous books in the English language were written by George Eliot. But “George Eliot” was not the writer’s real name. George Eliot was really a woman named Mary Anne Evans. She lived in England from 1819 to 1880. During her life, she wrote seven books, but she didn’t use her real name for her writing. She used a man’s name instead.

Mary Anne Evans wrote her first book in 1859. At that time, many women were writing books, and some of these women were famous. But men thought that women could not write good books. They said that women only wrote stories about getting married. Evans used a man’s name because she wanted to write about other things. She wrote about the lives and problems of people in small towns in England. Many people said that George Eliot was a great writer.

At first, no one knew that George Eliot was a woman. Then, a man said that he was George Eliot. So Evans had to tell people her secret,* and soon she became well known. But she still used the name George Eliot for her books because the name was already famous. Many people say that Eliot’s *Middlemarch* is one of the greatest books in the English language. This book is about many kinds of people and their lives. People began to think differently about women writers because of Eliot’s books. Thanks to her, women today can write about anything, so they can become great writers.

*secret: ひみつ
秘密

(31) What did Mary Anne Evans do when she wrote books?

- 1 She taught people to read.
 - 2 She lived alone.
 - 3 She studied languages.
 - 4 She used the name of a man.
-

(32) What did men think about women around 1859?

- 1 They couldn't write books well.
 - 2 They didn't want to get married.
 - 3 They had too many secrets.
 - 4 They didn't like living in England.
-

(33) Why did Evans have to tell her secret?

- 1 A man said he was George Eliot.
 - 2 She wanted to meet other women writers.
 - 3 People weren't buying her new books.
 - 4 People didn't like her real name.
-

(34) Many people say *Middlemarch*

- 1 is about the life of Mary Anne Evans.
 - 2 wasn't written by George Eliot.
 - 3 wasn't popular with women.
 - 4 is a great English book.
-

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 A woman who changed people's ideas.
- 2 A man who wrote about getting married.
- 3 A popular book about learning English.
- 4 A great book written by a group of writers.

4

C

つぎ えいぶん ないよう かん
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Ray Charles

Ray Charles was a famous musician from the United States. He made a new kind of music. He mixed* jazz and other types of music together. He even used church music. People also remember him because he was blind,* and he always wore sunglasses.

Ray Charles Robinson was born in 1930. His family was poor. When he was only three years old, he saw a man who was playing the piano at a café. From that time, music was his favorite thing. When he was five, he couldn't see well. Then, when he was seven, he became blind. His mother didn't want him to become sad, so she found a special school for him.

Charles went to a school for blind children. There, he learned a special kind of writing called Braille.* He used it to read and write music. He also listened to many types of music there.

When Charles was 15, his mother died. After he finished school, he started to travel around and play music with a band. At that time, there was a famous boxer called Sugar Ray Robinson. Charles didn't want to have the same name, so he changed his name to Ray Charles.

At first, people thought his new music was strange because he mixed different types of music together. But more and more people started to like his music. He became famous and won many prizes for his music. Now, many people say that he was one of the best musicians of the 20th century.

*mix: 混ぜる

*blind: 盲目の

*Braille: (ブライユ) 点字

-
- (31) Why was Ray Charles famous?
- 1 He made a new kind of music.
 - 2 He played music at different churches.
 - 3 He sold sunglasses to blind people.
 - 4 He taught music in many countries.
-
- (32) How old was Charles when he started to like music?
- 1 Three.
 - 2 Five.
 - 3 Seven.
 - 4 Fifteen.
-
- (33) At a special school, Charles
- 1 was sad because he had few friends.
 - 2 taught Braille to the other children.
 - 3 started to play and travel around with a band.
 - 4 learned how to read and write music in Braille.
-
- (34) Why did Charles change his name?
- 1 His mother asked him to change it.
 - 2 He wanted the same name as his band.
 - 3 It was the same as a famous boxer's.
 - 4 It was difficult for him to remember.
-
- (35) What is this story about?
- 1 A popular band in the 20th century.
 - 2 A blind man who won prizes for his music.
 - 3 How to read and write music in Braille.
 - 4 A famous boxer who was also in a band.

4

C

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 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

The Fishing Cat

Many people think that all cats don't like water. Most pet cats don't like to swim, but wild cats such as lions and tigers often go in the water. These cats live in hot places. However, wild cats in colder places usually don't go in the water at all.

The fishing cat is a wild cat that lives by rivers and other areas with water in Southeast Asia and the Middle East. It is an excellent swimmer and can even swim underwater. The cat can swim because of the shape of its feet. The fishing cat also uses its wide, flat* tail to swim better.

All cats eat meat, so they must catch other animals for food. Most wild cats catch their food on land, but fishing cats get most of their food from the water. They usually eat fish, frogs, and other animals found in water. The fishing cat moves its paw* above the water and then touches the top of the water. When the water moves, fish think there is food. When a fish comes close, the fishing cat catches it with its paws. The cat can also swim and catch fish with its teeth.

These days, people are making more roads and farms near rivers, so there is more pollution* in the water. The pollution kills fish and other animals in the water, so fishing cats can't find enough food. Because of this, the number of fishing cats is getting smaller. People should take care of the environment for these and other animals.

*flat: 平^{たい}らな

*paw: (動物^{どうぶつ}の) 足^{あし}

*pollution: 汚^お染^{せん}

(31) What kind of wild cats often go in the water?

- 1 Ones that live in cold places.
- 2 Ones that live in hot places.
- 3 Ones that live in mountains.
- 4 Ones that live with people.

(32) A fishing cat uses its tail

- 1 to swim better.
- 2 to fight other animals.
- 3 to carry its food.
- 4 to run faster.

(33) What does a fishing cat usually eat?

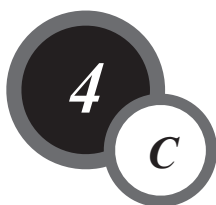
- 1 Flying animals, like birds.
- 2 Small animals on land, like mice.
- 3 Swimming animals, like frogs.
- 4 Farm animals, like chickens.

(34) Why is the number of fishing cats getting smaller now?

- 1 Water pollution is killing their food.
- 2 They cannot swim in dirty water.
- 3 More people are keeping them as pets.
- 4 They cannot live near other animals.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 An interesting kind of cat.
- 2 Pets that like the water.
- 3 How to teach a cat to swim.
- 4 Where to see wild cats.



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Festival of Radishes*

There are many festivals around the world. One of the most interesting festivals in Mexico is called the Night of the Radishes. This festival began over 100 years ago and is held every year on December 23 in the city of Oaxaca.* Oaxaca is famous because many artists live in the area. They sell their art there. For the Night of the Radishes, these artists make interesting art from large red radishes.

Farmers in the Oaxaca area usually grow small red radishes until the fall, and then people buy and eat them. However, the radishes for the festival need to be very large. So, the farmers grow some of them until December. This makes the radishes larger, but people don't eat them. The big ones are about 3 kilograms and 50 centimeters long. The artists carve* these big radishes and make many kinds of art. The radish art looks like people and other things. The artists put them all together to make scenes* of famous stories or parties. A contest is held, and a prize is given to the artist with the best radish art. The winner gets about 1,000 dollars.

The city of Oaxaca is popular because of this festival. Thousands of people come from all over the world, and they often must wait for hours to see the radish art. They also spend money in stores and restaurants. People in Oaxaca enjoy this busy time. The Night of the Radishes is a special festival that is good for artists, farmers, and tourists.

*radish: は っ か だいこん
二十日大根

*Oaxaca: オアハカ (メキシコ南部の州都)

*carve: ほ
彫る

*scene: ば めん
場面

(31) Why is the city of Oaxaca famous?

- 1** It has a lot of festivals.
 - 2** There are many artists there.
 - 3** A lot of fruit is grown there.
 - 4** It is the biggest city in Mexico.
-

(32) What is special about the radishes used in the festival?

- 1** They don't taste good.
 - 2** They are very expensive.
 - 3** They come from far away.
 - 4** They are very large.
-

(33) The winner of the contest will get

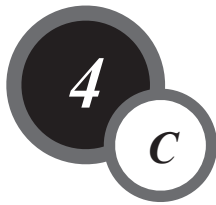
- 1** a ticket to a dance party.
 - 2** a lot of free radishes.
 - 3** a prize of money.
 - 4** a free dinner at a restaurant.
-

(34) What do foreign visitors often have to do during the festival?

- 1** Wait for hours to see the art.
 - 2** Make pieces of art for the festival.
 - 3** Write stories about the festival.
 - 4** Work on farms around the city.
-

(35) What is the story about?

- 1** A city in Mexico with large buildings.
- 2** A popular kind of Mexican food.
- 3** A famous radish farmer from Oaxaca.
- 4** A special event with interesting art.



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A Popular Writer

Agatha Christie is a famous mystery story* writer. She has sold 4 billion books around the world. Only William Shakespeare has sold more books. Also, her books are written in more languages than any other writer's books. People can read them in 103 different languages. Christie also wrote plays.* One of them is called *The Mousetrap*, and it started over 60 years ago. It is still playing at a theater now. That is longer than any other play.

In Christie's stories, someone usually has done something bad. It is hard to find that person. There is a detective* who tries to catch the bad person. People like reading her books because they can try to find the answer, too. Reading these books is like playing a game.

Christie wrote stories about a detective called Hercule Poirot. Poirot is a strange man from Belgium. Another famous detective in her books is Miss Marple. Miss Marple is an old English lady. People do not think she is smart, but she always finds the bad person. The stories of Poirot and Miss Marple were made into many TV shows and movies.

Christie was born in 1890 in Devon, England. She did not go to school. She had lessons from her mother at home. Her mother thought children should not learn to read until they were eight years old. But Christie learned how to read by herself when she was four. She read many books, so she learned to become a good writer. She later became a very good pianist and singer, too.

*mystery story: すいり しゅうせつ 推理小説

*play: えんげき 演劇

*detective: たんてい 探偵

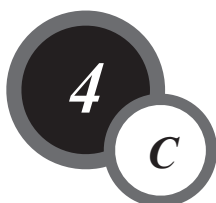
- (31) Why is Agatha Christie so famous?
- 1 She could speak many languages very well.
 - 2 She was in the same play for over 60 years.
 - 3 She has sold 4 billion books around the world.
 - 4 She wrote more plays than William Shakespeare.

- (32) Why do people like reading Christie's books?
- 1 Her stories are about her children.
 - 2 Her stories are like playing a game.
 - 3 Christie is a detective in them.
 - 4 Bad things don't happen in them.

- (33) Hercule Poirot and Miss Marple are
- 1 detectives in Christie's stories.
 - 2 an interesting couple from Belgium.
 - 3 writers of detective stories.
 - 4 actors in TV shows and movies.

- (34) How did Christie learn to read?
- 1 She studied at a school in Devon.
 - 2 She learned at a music school.
 - 3 She learned by herself when she was four.
 - 4 She studied different languages.

- (35) What is this story about?
- 1 A good way to teach people to read.
 - 2 TV shows and movies about children.
 - 3 The oldest and most famous theater in England.
 - 4 A woman who wrote interesting and popular books.



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A Clean New Year

In Thailand, there is a festival in April called Songkran. This is Thailand's New Year's party. Songkran is celebrated all over the country for three days. However, in the northern city of Chiang Mai, it is six days. Long ago, Thai people used a different calendar from other places in the world. Their year started around April 13. Now, their year starts on January 1, but they still celebrate the New Year from April 13 to April 15.

During Songkran, Thai people throw water at each other in the streets. It is exciting. Almost everyone gets wet, even the police. People put water on old people's hands. The only people who do not get wet are monks* and babies. People throw water for many reasons. The most important one is to have a clean body and mind for the new year. In Thailand, it is very hot at that time of year. So, people do not get angry when they get wet.

In Thailand, most people are Buddhist,* so they keep statues* of Buddha. On April 14, people dance and sing in the streets. They also carry their statues. They throw water at the Buddha statues to clean them. The water smells nice because it has flowers in it. The streets smell good during Songkran. Sometimes there is a contest to choose the most beautiful woman.

Another thing people do at this time is they clean their houses. They also wear new clothes. All these things show that people are ready for the new year.

*monk: 僧侶 (そうりょ)

*Buddhist: 仏教徒 (ぶつきょうと)

*statue: 像 (ぞう)

(31) How long is Songkran in Chiang Mai?

- 1 One day.
- 2 Three days.
- 3 Six days.
- 4 One month.

(32) Who doesn't get wet during Songkran?

- 1 The monks and babies.
- 2 The people with Buddha statues.
- 3 The police.
- 4 The old people.

(33) The most important reason to throw water is

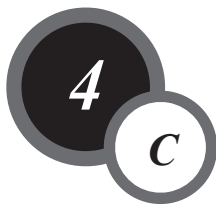
- 1 there is no rainy season in Thailand.
- 2 there are many people with dirty clothes.
- 3 people get thirsty during that time of year.
- 4 people want to clean their bodies and minds.

(34) When do people carry Buddha statues through the streets?

- 1 On January 1.
- 2 On April 1.
- 3 On April 13.
- 4 On April 14.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 How Thailand celebrates the New Year.
- 2 The best way to clean streets in big cities.
- 3 A special contest for visitors to Thailand.
- 4 The kind of water used by Thai people.



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Boxing Day

The day after Christmas, December 26, is the holiday known as Boxing Day. But the name does not come from the sport of boxing.* There are interesting stories about the history of the holiday. Some people think Boxing Day began in England early in the 10th century. An English king went outside on the day after Christmas and saw a poor man. The kind king gave the man food and money. After that, rich people began to give gifts to poor people and workers on December 26. They often put food from their Christmas dinner and some money into boxes. The name Boxing Day was given because people put the gifts in boxes.

In the United States, volunteer groups give food, money, clothing, and other things to poor people on Christmas Day, but people there do not celebrate Boxing Day. However, it is still celebrated in countries such as England, Australia, New Zealand, and Canada. Most people in those countries like Boxing Day because they can have another holiday after Christmas Day. They can enjoy leftover* Christmas food and watch sports on TV. In Canada, most people do not have to work on Boxing Day. They often go shopping because stores have special sales. Some stores open very early in the morning on that day. People stand in front of the stores while it is still dark outside and wait until they open. There are also many sports events, such as ice hockey games. In England, soccer games and horse races are very popular on Boxing Day.

*boxing: ボクシング

*leftover: 食べ残しの

(31) Where do some people think Boxing Day started?

- 1 In Canada.
- 2 In the United States.
- 3 In England.
- 4 In France.

(32) What did people often give to poor people and workers on December 26 a long time ago?

- 1 TVs.
- 2 Tickets to sports events.
- 3 New clothes.
- 4 Food and money.

(33) Why do people today like Boxing Day in countries such as England, Australia, New Zealand, and Canada?

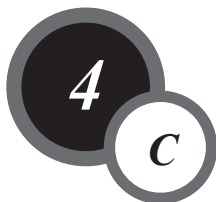
- 1 They can sell things to other people.
- 2 They can get money from their friends.
- 3 They can have another holiday after Christmas Day.
- 4 They can learn to play different sports.

(34) What do many people in Canada do on Boxing Day now?

- 1 They shop at special sales.
- 2 They play soccer games.
- 3 They ride horses.
- 4 They go to work.

(35) What is this story about?

- 1 A special food from England.
- 2 A very kind king from Canada.
- 3 A new American sport.
- 4 A holiday with an interesting history.



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England's Drink

England's most popular drink is tea. But people in England started drinking tea thousands of years later than people in China. How did a drink from China become so popular in England?

People in China started drinking tea about 5,000 years ago. Tea was first brought to Europe by some Portuguese* people around 1560. After that, Dutch* people started bringing tea to Europe, too. In 1662, the King of England married a woman who came from Portugal. The new queen loved to drink tea. She started drinking tea in London, so many rich people began to drink it, too. In 1700, more than 500 coffee shops in London sold tea.

By 1750, tea was the most popular drink in England. There was a big British company called the East India Company. The company brought tea from China to England. It was the only company that could sell tea in England. Because of this, tea was very expensive. Only rich people could drink it. Rich women had special parties to drink it with their friends. But everyone else wanted to drink tea, too. They started buying it secretly* from other places. Then, tea prices became cheaper, and everyone was happy.

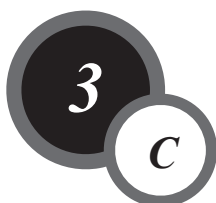
People in England like drinking tea with breakfast. Thanks to Anna Russell, a friend of the queen, afternoon tea is also popular. Around 1840, she thought of an idea. English people had late dinners. She was always hungry during the day, so she started having tea and snacks in the afternoon. Now, afternoon tea is a famous English tradition.

*Portuguese: ポルトガルの

*Dutch: オランダの

*secretly: ひそかに

-
- (31) Who first brought tea to Europe?
- 1 Some Chinese people.
 - 2 Some Dutch people.
 - 3 Some Italian people.
 - 4 Some Portuguese people.
-
- (32) Why did tea become popular with rich people in England?
- 1 People from China came to live in London.
 - 2 The new Queen of England liked drinking it.
 - 3 The King of Portugal brought tea to London.
 - 4 Many coffee shops stopped selling coffee.
-
- (33) Tea was the most popular drink in England by
- 1 1662.
 - 2 1700.
 - 3 1750.
 - 4 1840.
-
- (34) Why did Anna Russell first have afternoon tea?
- 1 She was hungry because she had dinner late.
 - 2 She didn't eat breakfast or lunch.
 - 3 It was a famous English tradition.
 - 4 Her friends always visited her at that time.
-
- (35) What is this story about?
- 1 The kings and queens of Europe.
 - 2 The history of tea in England.
 - 3 Tea companies around the world.
 - 4 Popular places to drink tea in England.



つぎ えいぶん ないよう かん
次の英文の内容に関して、(26) から (30) までの質問に対する答えとして
もっと てきせつ ふん かんせい もっと てきせつ
最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを 1, 2,
3, 4 の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Visiting Uruguay

The country of Uruguay in South America is a fun place to be during the months of February and March. During that time, there is a festival called Carnival. Carnival is held in many countries around the world. But in Uruguay, Carnival has its own special musical performance.

At that time of the year, it is summer in Uruguay. Everybody goes into the streets, from old people to children. There are people dancing, singing, and playing a special kind of music. This kind of dance and music is called *murga*.

People do *murga* performances in groups. The biggest groups have 17 people. They wear funny clothes with lots of colors. They play the drums and sing. The members of the groups are not professional singers or dancers. They are people with other jobs. Each group prepares and practices their own dance and songs for months. Then, they try to be the best group at the festival. Each group's dance and songs last about 45 minutes. The songs are stories about important people or events in the news, so people think watching *murga* is like watching a play at the theater.

Uruguay is a small country with just 3.5 million people. More than half of them live in the capital city, Montevideo. So the biggest festival at that time of the year is there. Uruguay's Carnival started over 100 years ago. It is the world's longest and is about 40 days long. People still work during that time, but in the evenings and on weekends, they enjoy the festival.

(26) How is Carnival in Uruguay different from other Carnivals?

- 1 It is held at a different time of year.
- 2 It has a special musical show.
- 3 It takes place twice a year.
- 4 Old people and children go to it.

(27) How long is each group's performance?

- 1 About 17 minutes.
- 2 About 35 minutes.
- 3 About 45 minutes.
- 4 About 100 minutes.

(28) Why do people think watching *murga* is like watching a theater play?

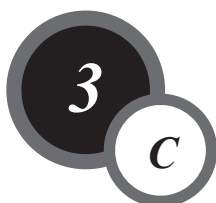
- 1 The people do it in large groups.
- 2 The people wear funny clothes with many colors.
- 3 The songs are about stories in the news.
- 4 It goes on for many months.

(29) The biggest festival is in the city of Montevideo because

- 1 many people live in that city.
- 2 it is very hot there at that time of year.
- 3 it has a lot of theaters.
- 4 people have longer holidays there.

(30) What is this story about?

- 1 Carnivals around the world.
- 2 Where to live in South America.
- 3 A long and special festival in Uruguay.
- 4 A new and funny kind of movie.



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London's Bicycles

There are many ways to travel around London, England. The subway train system, the Tube, is famous because it is quick, and people can use the Internet for free at all 270 stations in the city. But some people think it is too expensive to ride. Also, it is often crowded and hot, and people can't see much through the windows. Now, many people get around by bicycle.

Today, people who need bicycles can rent* them. This started in July 2010. A big bank gave money to the city to buy the bicycles. At the time, Boris Johnson was the mayor* of London, so people called the bicycles Boris Bikes.

People can rent bicycles in London at any time of the day or night. People can find them at places called docking stations. First, people pay money to rent a bicycle. Then, they get a number to unlock* it. After using the bicycle, people can return it to any docking station. If the bike ride is less than 30 minutes, people don't have to pay any more money.

When the bicycle service started, there were 5,000 bicycles and 315 docking stations in London. In 2012, there were about 8,000 bicycles and 570 docking stations. During the 2012 London Olympics, bicycles were rented 47,105 times on just one day.

People use the bicycles for different reasons. Visitors to London think they are a cheap way to see the city. Many people who work there think cycling is healthy and better for the environment, too.

*rent: ～を借りる

*mayor: 市長

*unlock: ～を開錠する

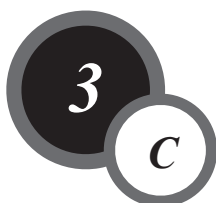
- (26) Why is the Tube famous?
- 1 People can take nice photos from the windows.
 - 2 It is very old, and tickets are cheap.
 - 3 People can borrow computers at the stations.
 - 4 It is a fast way to travel, and the Internet is free.

- (27) Why are the bicycles called Boris Bikes?
- 1 Boris is the name of a popular place in London.
 - 2 Boris was the name of a famous bicycle company.
 - 3 Boris was the name of the mayor of London.
 - 4 Boris is the name of the bank that bought the bicycles.

- (28) People don't have to pay more money if
- 1 they use a bicycle during the Olympics.
 - 2 they are visiting London on a holiday.
 - 3 they use a bicycle for less than 30 minutes.
 - 4 they keep a bicycle all day and night.

- (29) How many bicycles were there in 2012?
- 1 About 315.
 - 2 About 570.
 - 3 About 5,000.
 - 4 About 8,000.

- (30) What is this story about?
- 1 How to travel around England by train.
 - 2 A cheap and healthy way to travel around London.
 - 3 Why subway trains are bad for the environment.
 - 4 The life of the new mayor of London.



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Sally Ride

Sally Ride was the first American woman to go into space. She was born in California in 1951. When she was growing up, she loved math, science, and tennis. In high school, she became a very good tennis player. In fact, she was one of the best players in America. At that time, she wanted to become a professional tennis player. She practiced hard every day for months, but then she changed her mind. She decided to go to college instead.

Sally went to Stanford University. There, she studied science and English. Later, she got a Ph.D.* in astrophysics.* Then, in 1977, she read an advertisement* in the newspaper. It said NASA* was looking for people who wanted to become astronauts. Sally wanted the job, and she got it. She went to the Johnson Space Center in Houston, Texas, and trained to become an astronaut.

In 1983, Sally was able to go into space. Russia sent women into space in 1963 and 1982, but Sally was the first American woman to go. Her second and final trip to space was in 1984. She worked for NASA for several more years, and then she worked at Stanford University. Later, she had her own company called Sally Ride Science, and she also wrote several books.

Sadly, Sally died in 2012. However, many people remember the important things she did. In fact, in 2013, President Barack Obama gave her a special award. Also, two elementary schools are named after her. Sally is still a hero for many people.

*Ph.D.: 博士号

*astrophysics: 天体物理学

*advertisement: 広告

*NASA: 米国航空宇宙局

(26) What did Sally Ride want to be when she was in high school?

- 1** A scientist.
 - 2** A college teacher.
 - 3** A tennis player.
 - 4** An astronaut.
-

(27) How did Sally find out about the job at NASA?

- 1** She read about it in the newspaper.
 - 2** She got a call from the Johnson Space Center.
 - 3** Her friend in Houston told her about it.
 - 4** She saw a poster at Stanford University.
-

(28) How many times did Sally go to space?

- 1** Once.
 - 2** Twice.
 - 3** Three times.
 - 4** Four times.
-

(29) What did President Barack Obama do in 2013?

- 1** He wrote a book about Sally's life.
 - 2** He named a school after Sally.
 - 3** He started the company Sally Ride Science.
 - 4** He gave Sally a special award.
-

(30) What is this story about?

- 1** An important American astronaut.
- 2** The first woman to become the president.
- 3** A famous American tennis player.
- 4** A popular teacher who visited Russia.